Activity 05 - Community Portrait Campaign: Natural Masking and Retouching

Course: Adobe Lightroom Masterclass Course Code: C200 Alignment: Topic 2
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Detailed Lightroom production workflow

Before you begin

1. Work only on the supplied practice images or other images for which you have explicit permission.
2. Create an evidence/ folder and preserve the source files unchanged.
3. Open the current Lightroom interface available to you; menu names can vary slightly across desktop, web, mobile, and Classic.
4. Save a screenshot whenever the workflow asks you to prove a setting, comparison, mask, search, permission, or export result.

Procedure

1. Review the brief and write down identity, authenticity, and prohibited-edit constraints.
2. Correct profile, white balance, and global tone without changing the intended atmosphere.
3. Use Select People or Select Subject and inspect hair, clothing, facial skin, eyes, and teeth selections.
4. Refine the subject boundary with Add, Subtract, Intersect, Feather, and Edge as available.
5. Lift the face with small exposure or shadow changes; avoid flattening facial modelling.
6. Use Texture and Clarity conservatively and preserve pores and defining features.
7. Create an inverse/background mask and reduce competition with tone or saturation rather than obvious blur.
8. Use Heal for small blemishes or sensor spots and reserve Remove/Generative Remove for appropriate distractions.
9. Inspect all altered areas at 100% for repeated texture, halos, warped edges, and invented detail.
10. Compare the image at fit view and on a second display or mobile preview.
11. Ask the subject advocate to review authenticity and record any requested reversal.
12. Export a proof with metadata and a short edit-disclosure note.

Review with stakeholders

1. Present the before/after comparison and the evidence, not only the finished image.
2. Ask reviewers to respond against the brief and acceptance criteria.
3. Record the decision owner, requested change, approval status, and next action.
4. Retain rejected versions when they explain a material decision.

Debrief questions

1. Which changes improve attention without changing identity?
2. Where did mask refinement matter most?
3. Which retouching tool was least intrusive?

4. What should be disclosed to the stakeholder?